

The Synthetic Chess Primer

Chapter 1: Weak Squares

1.1 Understanding weak squares

A weak square is a square that can no longer be defended by a pawn.

Once such a square exists, a piece that occupies it is very hard to remove.

1.2 Exploiting weak squares

The knight is the ideal piece to occupy a weak square, since it cannot be challenged by an enemy pawn once it lands there.

White to move. Find the best move.

Diagram 1.1

Chapter 2: Outposts

2.1 The model game

The following game shows the outpost idea in a full practical example.

1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7

2.2 Exercises

Exercise 1: Black to move. Find the continuation.